

Owens & Minor, Inc.

Screening Test/Interview Questions for Security Analyst (Remote) Position

Instructions: Please precede all your answers with the question you are answering.
Use acronyms only after you've explained them.
Use correct spelling and grammar.
Be sure to write your name and the interviewer's name.

Candidate's Name: Samuel Agboola

Interviewer's Name:

1. **Are you currently employed?** No. I recently graduated from college and I currently focus on honing my skills with real world experience.

2. **Can you tell us some basic information about yourself?** I hold a Master's Degree in Cybersecurity from Southern Illinois University with CGPA of 4.0. I also hold the CompTIA Security+ certification. My background combines cybersecurity training, hands-on labs, security operations, investigations, incident documentation, and risk awareness. I have worked with tools and concepts such as SIEM, Splunk basics, Wireshark, Nessus, Windows, and Linux logs, vulnerability, digital forensics, and incident response. I bring to your team is the maturity in calmly handling investigations, strong and detailed documentation, escalation discipline, and ability to protect sensitive environment. Since Owens and Minor supports healthcare operations, I understand that security is tied to business continuity and protecting sensitive data. I come with lots of years of experience in training deliveries.

3. **Can you describe a time when you successfully trained a group to use a particularly different security protocol?** Yes. In a previous security operations role, I trained personnel on a new evidence handling and incident reporting protocol. Many of them were used to different reporting styles, so I simplified the process into clear steps: identify the incident, secure the area, document facts, preserve chain of custody, notify the right people, and escalate properly.

I used real scenarios and sample reports to make the training practical. As a result, reporting became more consistent, documentation improved, and supervisors had better information for decision-making. That experience showed

me that a security protocol is only effective when people understand how to apply it in real situations.

4. What would you do to assess a company's security needs and what are some significant trends in cyber security that interest you? I would first understand what the company does and what systems and data are most important. Then I would check the company's current security controls, like access control, multi-factor authentication, logs, endpoint protection, patching, backups, and incident response.

After that, I would rank the risks and focus on the most dangerous ones first. Asset criticality will be considered. Past security incidents, audit findings and common risks in the industry would interest me.

The cybersecurity trends that interest me are ransomware, identity security, and artificial intelligence. Ransomware interests me because it can stop business operations. Identity security is important because many attacks start with stolen accounts. Artificial intelligence is also important because both attackers and defenders are now using it.

5. What changes did you last make to your private network that fixed a weakness in your security? One good example is from my malware analysis lab. Before running a live malware sample, I realized the biggest weakness was the network setup. If I left the virtual machine connected to the public internet, the malware could possibly call out to a real command and control server or try to spread outside the lab.

So I hardened the lab first. I removed the temporary internet access I had used for setup, moved the machines back to an isolated network, and used INetSim to simulate fake internet services inside the lab. I also checked the Domain Name System settings and confirmed that traffic was going only to my lab server, not to the public internet. That made the lab safer and gave me a controlled space to observe the malware behavior using Wireshark. It was a good reminder that a small network setting can create a big security risk if it is not fixed before testing.

6. How would you report weakness in the system security of a company to the IT administrators? I would not just tell them "there is a problem." I would give clear details: what the weakness is, where it is, why it matters, and what can be done to fix it. Then I would follow up until it is resolved.

7. What are the qualities of a successful analyst? Why are these qualities important? A successful analyst should be curious, calm, detail-oriented, honest, and a good communicator. These virtues are important because analysts must investigate alerts carefully, avoid panic, document clearly, explain risks, and escalate issues properly. In cybersecurity, one missed detail can become a serious incident.

8. How do you make sure you're consistently meeting your goals? I stay organized by knowing what is important, breaking the work into steps, and tracking what is done by creating a checklist. I am also very goal-oriented. I do not just stop because my duty hours are over. If something important needs to be completed, documented, escalated, or handed over, I make sure it reaches a logical end first, even if it warrants me working into the night. I built that discipline over the years and also while completing my Master's degree in Cybersecurity.

9. Have you ever had a conflict with another team member? If so, how did you resolve it? Yes. During a cybersecurity lab, I had a disagreement with a team member about how the work was being handled. Instead of challenging him in front of the group, I called him aside and spoke with him privately. I explained my concern calmly, listened to his side, and reminded him that our goal was to complete the lab correctly. After that, we agreed on clear responsibilities and improved our communication. The lab went better after that, and I learned that private, respectful communication can solve many team issues before they become bigger problems. This is a skill I developed after decades of working with people from diverse nationality, opinions and cultures.

10. How did you positively contribute to your current or previous position? I positively contributed by improving documentation, supporting incident reporting, and helping the team follow security procedures more clearly. In my previous security operations work, I made sure incidents were properly recorded, evidence was handled carefully, and important issues were escalated to the right people. I also helped guide team members so everyone understood the process better. In cybersecurity, I bring the same discipline to alert review, investigation, documentation, and risk management.

11. What sort of analysis are you comfortable performing? I am comfortable analyzing security alerts, logs, suspicious login activity, phishing indicators, vulnerability scan results, endpoint alerts, and network traffic. I am also comfortable with incident analysis, where I review what happened, what system was affected, what evidence is available, and what action should follow. My strength is careful review, clear documentation, and proper escalation.

12. What are your greatest strengths as an analyst and why do you want to perform analysis for our company? My strengths are that I am curious, careful, calm, and good with documentation. I do not rush to close alerts. I check the facts, review the evidence, document clearly, and escalate when needed. I want to do analysis for Owens and Minor because the company supports healthcare operations. That makes the security work important and meaningful.

13. Will you be able to devote 30 to 40 hours of your time weekly for the company? Yes, I can devote 30 to 40 hours weekly to the company. I am disciplined and goal-oriented. I understand that security work requires consistency, focus, and proper follow-through. I will make sure my assigned work is completed, documented, escalated, or properly handed over when needed.

14. How long would you expect to work for us if hired and how much will you request per hour if you are hired? I would like to work with the company long term if hired. I am looking for a stable role where I can grow, contribute, and become stronger as a Security Analyst. For compensation, I would like to understand the company's approved range for the role. Based on my education, certification, and security operations background, I believe \$35 to \$40 per hour is reasonable, but I am flexible for the right opportunity.

15. When can you start working with us if we offer you this position? I can start immediately once my Employment Authorization Document is approved and received. My application is already pending with United States Citizenship and Immigration Services, and I am willing to pay for premium processing to help speed up the decision if I receive the offer.

Responsibilities of a Security Analyst

You're to be in charge of producing reports for IT administrators and business managers in order to assess the effectiveness of security measures in place. You will then assist with making the required adjustments to make the network more secure, as well as developing training programmes and modules to educate workers and users on correct security standards.

Finally you're to be in charge of maintaining the company's security systems up to date, as well as providing documentation and planning for any security-related data, such as incident response and backup and recovery.

Among the other specified roles are:

- Keeping an eye on security access

- Vulnerability testing and risk analysis are used to conduct security assessments.
- Internal and external security audits are carried out.
- Identifying the fundamental cause of security breaches
- Keeping the company's incident response and catastrophe recovery plans up to date.
- Verifying third-party vendor security and working with them to achieve security needs.

Can you handle all of these duties effectively? Yes, I can handle the duties, however, I am still improving my skills.

I would first study the company playbook, understand the tools and process, and ask the right questions where needed. I am comfortable with reports, documentation, risk analysis, incident response, access monitoring, vulnerability management, and security training. I will not pretend to know everything immediately, but I am a fast learner, follow procedures, and take responsibility seriously.